

UC2: Create Auction Listing

Primary Actor: Seller

Stakeholders and Interests:

- *Seller*: wants to list an item quickly and easily, and trusts it will be presented fairly to buyers
- *Bidder*: wants accurate, well-organized listings they can trust and filter through
- *Admin*: wants listings to comply with platform rules (no spam/fraud) so moderation stays manageable
- *System*: needs complete, valid data to calculate timers, categorize the item, and enforce reserve/increment rules later

Preconditions:

- Seller is logged in with a verified account
- Seller has selected "List an Item"

Postconditions (success):

- A new auction listing is created with status "Active"
- Auction end time is calculated and stored based on selected duration
- Listing appears in the relevant category and on the homepage/browse grid
- Starting price is set as the current highest bid (with no bids yet)

Main Success Scenario:

1. Seller selects "List an Item" from their dashboard.
2. System displays the listing form (title, description, photo upload, category dropdown, starting price, optional reserve price, duration dropdown).
3. Seller fills in the title, description, and uploads one or more photos.
4. Seller selects a category (Gaming, Photography, Audio, Computers).
5. Seller enters a starting price.
6. Seller optionally enters a hidden reserve price.
7. Seller selects an auction duration (3, 5, 7, or 10 days).
8. Seller submits the form.
9. System validates all required fields are present and valid (see extensions).
10. System calculates the exact auction end timestamp based on duration.
11. System creates the listing with status "Active" and current price = starting price.
12. System displays the new listing on the homepage/browse grid under the selected category.
13. System confirms to the seller that the listing is live.

Extensions (Alternate Flows):

- **9a. Required field missing (e.g., no title, no photo, no starting price):**
 1. System rejects the submission.
 2. System highlights the missing field(s) and displays a clear message.
 3. Seller corrects the form and resubmits (back to step 8).
- **9b. Starting price is invalid (e.g., zero, negative, or non-numeric):**
 1. System rejects the submission.
 2. System displays: "Please enter a valid starting price."
 3. Seller corrects and resubmits.
- **9c. Reserve price is lower than or equal to the starting price:**
 1. System rejects the reserve value (a reserve at or below the starting price is meaningless).
 2. System displays a message explaining the reserve must be higher than the starting price.
 3. Seller corrects and resubmits.
- **9d. Photo upload fails or no photo provided:**
 1. System rejects the submission (at least one photo required for trust/transparency).
 2. Seller re-uploads and resubmits.

Special Requirements:

- Reserve price value must never be exposed to bidders in any API response (enforced at the data layer, not just the UI) — relevant for your security/verification test cases.
- Duration options are fixed presets only (3/5/7/10 days); no free-text date entry, to keep end-time calculation simple and consistent for the soft-close logic in UC1.
- Category is a closed enum (four fixed values), not free text — needed for reliable homepage filtering.